

Olubanke D. Aduba

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EDUCATION

Ph.D. in Comparative Literature

Expected June 2025

University of California, Davis

Davis, CA

Major Field of Study: 17th Century British literature

Dissertation: "Two British Poets: A Comparative Study of the Conventions Used by Chaucer and Fletcher"

Master of Arts in Comparative Literature

June 2021

Michigan State University

East Lansing, MI

Bachelor of Arts in English

June 2019

San Jose State University

San Jose, CA

RESEARCH AND TEACHING INTERESTS

- Renaissance and 17th century literature and metaphysical poetry.
- Beginning and Advanced comparative literature courses.

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Researcher

Sept 2021 - Present

UC Davis Department of English

Davis, CA

- Research and analyze the literary conventions employed by Geoffrey Chaucer and John Fletcher, focusing on their impact and evolution within 17th Century British literature.
- Conduct extensive archival research to gather primary sources, including manuscripts, letters, and contemporary critiques, to inform the comparative study of Chaucer and Fletcher's works.
- Utilize qualitative and quantitative methods to analyze thematic elements, narrative structures, and linguistic features across 200+ texts, aiming to elucidate similarities and differences in their approaches to poetry.
- Developed theoretical frameworks to contextualize findings within broader literary movements of the 17th Century, such as Renaissance humanism and the emergence of neoclassicism.
- Presented research findings at 6 academic conferences and contributed over 25 articles to peer-reviewed journals, advancing scholarly discourse.
- Mentor 12 undergraduate students in research methodologies, assisting with literature reviews, data collection, and analysis, fostering a collaborative learning environment within the department.

Researcher

Sept 2019 - June 2021

Michigan State University Department of English

East Lansing, MI

- Investigated the evolution of European poetry from the 15th to the 18th centuries, with a focus on key themes, stylistic innovations, and socio-cultural influences.

- Conducted in-depth textual analyses of 120+ poems from diverse linguistic traditions, including English, French, Spanish, Italian, and German, to identify common trends and unique contributions within each literary tradition.
- Utilized historical and theoretical frameworks to contextualize poetic movements such as the Renaissance, Baroque, and Enlightenment periods, exploring their impact on poetic form, content, and audience reception.
- Collaborated with 2 faculty members and 5 researchers to develop interdisciplinary approaches to studying European poetry, integrating insights from history, philosophy, and cultural studies into literary analysis.
- Presented research findings to an audience of 90+ students and faculty at academic conferences, contributing to scholarly conversations on the intersections of literature, history, and cultural identity in early modern Europe.
- Recipient of Michigan State University's Outstanding Senior Award for exemplary contributions to the advancement of knowledge in the field and dedication to research.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Associate Instructor, Interpretation of Literature

January 2023 - Present

Department of Comparative Literature, UC Davis

Davis, CA

- Designed and implemented a comprehensive curriculum for the course "Interpretation of Literature," encompassing diverse literary genres, critical theories, and methodological approaches.
- Developed engaging and interactive course materials, including lecture presentations, reading assignments, and discussion prompts, to foster critical thinking and analytical skills among students.
- Provided personalized feedback and guidance to 120+ students on their academic progress, offering constructive criticism and suggestions for further development of their analytical and writing skills.
- Supervised and mentored a team of 3 teaching assistants, providing training, support, and resources to enhance their effectiveness in facilitating class discussions, grading assignments, and assisting students.
- Led bi-weekly meetings with teaching associates to discuss course objectives, instructional strategies, and student performance, fostering a collaborative and cohesive teaching environment within the department.

Teaching Assistant

Sept 2022 - Present

Department of English, UC Davis

Davis, CA

Solely responsible for lectures and exam evaluations for over 250 students. Held weekly office hours. Courses included:

- Narrative Literature (Fall 2022, Spring 2023)
- Freshman Composition (Winter 2023, Fall 2024)
- Lyric Poetry (upper division, Winter 2024, Fall 2024)

PUBLICATIONS

Aduba, O. (2023). "Writings in Black and Yellow: Afro-Asian Literature as Activism." *Comparative Critical Studies*, 13: 123–128.

Aduba, O. (2024). "From Ama Ata Aidoo to Chinua Achebe: Pan Africanism, Feminism, and The Legacy of African Literature". *The International Journal of Comparative Literature and Translation Studies*, 75: 65–81.

PRESENTATIONS AND CONFERENCES

Aduba, O. "Writing While Black: Black Women Poets in the Academy." Roundtable participant at the National Conference on Race and Ethnicity in Higher Education. March 12, 2024. Dallas, TX.

Aduba, O. "Afro-Asian Poetry." Poster presentation at the National Council for Black Studies. September 14, 2023. Los Angeles, CA.

Aduba, O. "From Slavery to Freedom: The Writings of Phyllis Wheatley." Paper presentation at the Interdisciplinary Graduate & Professional Student Symposium. April 19, 2023. Davis, CA.

FELLOWSHIPS AND AWARDS

Mellon Public Scholars Fellowship (\$20,000)	July 2024
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Outstanding Senior Award, Michigan State University	May 2021
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